73% of millionaires have never carried a credit-card balance in their lives.

I'm not just talking about credit card debt, either. Let's look at the driving habits of most millionaires for a minute. Do you think the typical millionaire drives a shiny new Lexus or Mercedes? Not likely. Do you think the typical millionaire wakes up on Saturday morning, decides to buy a new car by lunch, and drives a brand-new SUV home by dinner? The stats say no. When I say 95% save up for big purchases, that includes cars. Rather than hitting the lot and buying a brand-new car, we found the average millionaire drives a four-year-old car with 41,000 miles on it. And eight out of ten millionaire car buyers drive it away debt-free without carrying a car payment behind them. These wealthy people know that car payments and loan interest won't move them forward to financial independence.

If you've never calculated what a lifetime of car payments is really costing you, this will blow your mind. Cars.com reports that the average new-car payment is $509 a month.[23] If you did what millionaires do and paid cash for slightly used cars instead, you'd have $509 a month to invest toward retirement and wealth building. In thirty years, that $509 per month investment would break the millionaire mark at $1.1 million. In thirty-five years, it would hit $1.82 million. And—this is crazy—that same $509 per month investment would be worth $2.97 million in forty years. So, if you're in your thirties or forties right now, I just showed you how to become a multimillionaire with one simple trick. Like I've been saying, *anyone* can become a millionaire in America—even if you only invest the average car payment.

Debt is a mind-set that will wreck your wealth-building goals no matter where you are financially. If you genuinely want to become a millionaire someday, then you need to start acting like a millionaire *today*. That means